Liyi Zhou

***Email**: lzhou1110@gmail.com* ***Website**: lzhou1110.github.io* ***Updated:** August 1, 2026*

CS Lecturer (~US Assistant Professor) @ The University of Sydney

Selected Publications

Security & Reliability of AI Agents

Reliability Can Agent Benchmarks Support Their Scores? *arXiv'26*

S Gao, L Zhou.

Security Reliability When Agents Overtrust Environmental Evidence *arXiv'26*

S Sheng, Z Wang, L Zhou.

AI for Security

AI for Security Security EvoHunt: Transferable Self-Evolving Playbooks for Agentic Security Auditing *arXiv'26*

Z Wang, C W M Ng, C Yu, S Sheng, K Qin, L Zhou.

Core A AI for Security Security AI Agent Smart Contract Exploit Generation *FC'26*

A Gervais, L Zhou.

AI for Security Security Agentic Discovery and Validation of Android App Vulnerabilities *arXiv'25*

Ziyue Wang, L Zhou.

Blockchain

Core A* Security Privacy Evasion Under Blockchain Sanctions *WWW'26*

E Liu, M Ryan, L Zhou, P Berrang.

Core A* Security Blockchain Amplification Attack *ACM SIGMETRICS'25*

T Tsuchiya, L Zhou, K Qin, A Gervais, N Christin.

Core A* Security Speculative Denial-of-Service Attacks in Ethereum *USENIX Security'24*

A Yaish, K Qin, L Zhou, Aviv Zohar, A Gervais.

Core A* Security Smart Contract and DeFi Security Tools: Do They Meet the Needs of Practitioners? *ICSE'24*

S Chaliasos, M Charalambous, L Zhou, R Galanopoulou, A Gervais, D Mitropoulos, B Livshits.

Core A* Security Privacy SoK: Decentralized Finance (DeFi) Attacks *IEEE S&P'23*

L Zhou, X Xiong, J Ernstberger, S Chaliasos, Z Wang, Y Wang, K Qin, R Wattenhofer, D Song, A Gervais.

Core A* Security The Blockchain Imitation Game *USENIX Security'23*

K Qin, S Chaliasos, L Zhou, B Livshits, D Song, A Gervais.

Core A* Privacy On How Zero-Knowledge Proof Blockchain Mixers Improve, and Worsen User Privacy *WWW'23*

Z Wang, S Chaliasos, K Qin, L Zhou, L Gao, P Berrang, B Livshits, A Gervais.

Core A* Security Quantifying Blockchain Extractable Value: How dark is the forest? *IEEE S&P'22*

K Qin, L Zhou, A Gervais.

Core A* Security High-Frequency Trading on Decentralized On-Chain Exchanges *IEEE S&P'21*

L Zhou, K Qin, C Torres, D Le, A Gervais.

Core A* Security On the Just-In-Time Discovery of Profit-Generating Transactions in DeFi Protocols *IEEE S&P'21*

L Zhou, K Qin, A Cully, B Livshits, A Gervais.

Teaching

INFO5995: Introduction to Cybersecurity @ The University of Sydney *2026 Semester 1*

INFO2222: Computing 2 Usability and Security @ The University of Sydney *2025 Semester 1*

Services

Program Chair / Program Committee Co-Chair

Web3 Scholars Conference 2026

ACM CCS Workshop on Decentralized Finance and Security 2024, 2025

Program Committee

Core A* USENIX Security 2026

Core A* The ACM Conference on Computer and Communications Security (CCS) 2025, 2026

Core A Financial Cryptography and Data Security (FC) 2024, 2025, 2026, 2027

The Science of Blockchain (Stanford) 2023, 2024, 2025, 2026

The Latest in DeFi Research (TL;DR) 2024, 2025

CESC Crypto Economics Security Conference (UC Berkeley) 2022

ACM CCS Workshop on Decentralized Finance and Security 2021, 2022, 2023

Invited Reviewer

Transactions on Information Forensics & Security 2023

Financial Innovation 2021, 2022, 2023, 2024

Transactions on Dependable and Secure Computing 2023

External Reviewer

Core A* IEEE Symposium on Security and Privacy 2023

Awards and Grants

ARC DECRA Fellowship, 527,178 AUD, Advancing AI for Software Exploit Generation *Ongoing, 2026*

Sui Academic Research Awards, 25k USD *Awarded, 2025*

Innosuisse Start-Up Innovation, 703k CHF, AI-Enhanced Smart Contract Auditing *Completed, 2024*

Ethereum Academic Grant 2024, 55k USD, Training an EVM-native GPT *Completed, 2024*

Ethereum Academic Grant 2023, 72k USD, Blockchain Censorship DoS *Completed, 2023*

Ethereum Academic Grant 2023, 25k USD, Blockchain Censorship Measurement *Completed, 2023*

Education

PhD in Computer Science Imperial College London, United Kingdom *Oct 2019 – Feb 2025*

MRes in Web Science and Big Data Analytics University College London, United Kingdom *Oct 2017 – Sep 2018*

MSci & ARCS in Maths and Computer Science Imperial College London, United Kingdom *Oct 2010 – Sep 2014*

Other Experiences

Co-founder, Decentralized Intelligence AG (D23E)